Curriculum Vitae Anagha Soman

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RESEARCH INTERESTS:

- **Labour Economics**: Interested in understanding how labour market dynamics, unemployment duration, and intensity influence labour market outcomes.
- **Development Economics**: Interested in analysing how interactions of different socioeconomic factors influence employment opportunities and economic development, particularly in developing economies.

Education

M.A. Economics, University of Hyderabad, Hyderabad, Telangana, India ***2022 - 2024***

- CGPA: 7.75/10
- M.A. Thesis: "*Education and Employment Gap in Kerala: An Analysis of the Higher Education Sector*"
  Advisor: Prof.K Laxminarayana
- Key Courses: Macroeconomics II, Microeconomics II, Economics of Growth and Development, Indian Economy, Public Finance, Classical Political Economy, Political Economy of Development, Theories of International Trade and Finance
- Key Electives: Behavioral Economics, Institutional Economics, Environmental Economics, Econometrics, Optimization, Economics of Discrimination, Economics of Development

B.A. Economics, University College, Kerala University , Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India ***2018-2021***

- CGPA: 7.3/10
- BA Project : The usage of E-commerce platform during Covid-19 : A study on the youth of Kerala
  Advisor: Prof. Santhosh Kuamar
- Key Courses: Indian Economy, Kerala Economy, Agricultural Economics, Basic Tools for Economics, Microeconomics 1 and 2, Macroeconomics 1 and 2, International Economics, Economics of Growth
- Key Electives: Mathematics

Publications

1. **Vinoj Abraham and Anagha Soman, "Measuring unemployment intensity: A study on the Indian Labour force" (Working Paper) , October 2026**
   - Examines unemployment duration and severity in India using Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) data, with particular attention to long-term unemployment.
   - Develops an unemployment intensity index that incorporates both the incidence and duration of unemployment to capture employment distress beyond the unemployment rate.
   - Analyses differences in unemployment duration across demographic and socioeconomic groups and decomposes changes in unemployment into population, labour force participation, and unemployment rate effects.

2. **Angha V.S, Maheswari, K. Ragasuriya, and G. Sridevi, "The world is not ready to accept us", publication-Empirical Economics Letters, 24(May Special Issue 4), 29-39, 2025,**
   - The article stems from a project report completed during coursework under the guidance of Professor Gummadi Sridevi.
   - The project involved conducting a primary survey among 50 individuals from the transgender community, aiming to explore the socio-economic challenges they encounter in their daily lives and gain insights into their employment dynamics.

3. **Anagha Soman, "Education and Employment Gap in Kerala: An Analysis of the Higher Education Sector", (M.A. thesis) , May, 2024**

- The study uses both quantitative and qualitative analyses, drawing on data from the National Sample Survey Office (NSSO) and Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS).
- It analyzes trends in unemployment among various educational levels from 2020-2023 and the employment creation in different sectors.
- The study also assesses contemporary skill requirements and evaluates how higher education addresses skill mismatches and government initiatives.

Work Experience

Jun 2024-Present

Centre for Development Studies (CDS) - Research Assistant

- **Research mentor: Professor Vinoj Abraham**
- Worked under the guidance of Professor Vinoj Abraham on a project titled "National Research Programme on Plantation Development" (NRPPD), funded by the Ministry of Commerce; on the project on Urban Heat and Productivity, funded by Kyoto University, Japan; and currently working on the project to measure the unemployment intensity of India.
- Conducted extensive literature reviews on Tea, Coffee, Rubber, and Spices, focusing on the political economy of each crop.
- Performed comprehensive data analysis, including long-term yield trend assessments, and prepared policy briefs based on key findings to inform stakeholders and policymakers.
- Designed questionnaires and carried out surveys and focus group discussions.
- Coordinated field staff, communicated with stakeholders, mentored interns, and prepared presentations for stakeholder dissemination.
- Analysed primary and secondary data using Stata, including descriptive analysis and regression-based estimations, and contributed to the development of a heat vulnerability index to assess the risk across the population.
- Measuring the severity of unemployment in India using the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) microdata, extending the research undertaken for my Master's dissertation.
- Analysing trends in unemployment duration across categories to understand the disparities in Prolonged unemployment
- Developing an unemployment intensity index to capture the persistence of unemployment beyond the conventional unemployment rate, accounting for interval-reported durations and the open-ended longest-duration categor

School of Management studies, University of Hyderabad- Project intern ***Jun 2023-Aug 2023***

- In the project titled "Prototyping Simulation Game for Financial Literacy" under the supervision of Dr. Prasant Kumar.
- Conducted literature reviews, assisted with drafting questionnaires, and coordinated with external stakeholders and faculty members from other universities.
- The project was to design a simulation game to calculate a person's financial literacy of a person and to give financial advice based on the results.

Centre For Good Governance, Hyderabad- research intern ***Jun 2023-Jul 2023***

- For the state government projects "Me Seva" and "Telangana Diagnostics,"
- Researched and presented methodologies aimed at simplifying cost-effective analyses.
- Contributed to the preparation of comprehensive reports and worked extensively on data pertaining to digitalization efforts.
- Conducted an in-depth study and authored a report on the Economics of Diagnostics programs offered by the states of Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh, facilitating a comparative analysis.